

Weekly Intel – March 24, 2026

All podcast and blog resources are at the end of this document

Contents:

My Roster Intel
Injury Watch
Matchup Preview
Waiver Targets
Trade Signals
Projection Watch
Around the League
Cardinals Corner
Sibling Rivalry
Action Items
Sources Analyzed

My Roster Intel

Dennis Santana (PIT, RP)

Sentiment	BEARISH
Lineup	MONITOR
Confidence	MEDIUM (2 sources)
Games This Week	PIT: 4 games
Trend	— (first report)

This is a significant development that requires immediate attention. On Monday, Pirates manager Don Kelly indicated that the team could use multiple relievers for saves, with [Dennis Santana](#) potentially being deployed earlier in games rather than as a traditional closer. While Scott White of CBS dismissed this as typical managerial double-speak — noting that “every manager says these days” similar things — the key positive is that Kelly confirmed Santana is viewed as their highest-leverage arm. *Fantasy Baseball Today, CBS, Mar 24, 2026*. However, the FantasyPros NL Best Bets podcast also flagged this, with Joe Pisapia noting that Kelly “announced today that they’re not going to commit to a closer, that Dennis Santana will get some of them.” *FantasyPros*

Baseball Podcast, Mar 23, 2026. In our scoring system where SV=7, any erosion of save opportunities is costly. FanGraphs' bullpen rankings had Santana projected for 68 IP with a 3.72 ERA and 0.8 WAR — solid but not elite. The Pirates bullpen ranked 22nd overall. With only 4 games this week, the save volume concern is amplified. His composite projection of 364 pts already trails the league's top closers significantly. Monitor closely in Week 1 — if saves are indeed split, his value drops precipitously in our format.

Carlos Estévez (KC, RP)

Sentiment	BEARISH
Lineup	SELL HIGH / MONITOR
Confidence	HIGH (4 sources)
Games This Week	KC: 5 games
Trend	— (first report)

The alarm bells are ringing loudly on [Carlos Estévez](#). Multiple sources are reporting that his fastball velocity has plummeted six to eight miles per hour this spring, sitting around 89 mph when he was at 95.9 in the regular season last year. Scott White on Fantasy Baseball Today stated bluntly: "Carlos Estévez pitched in the spring again today. Six and a half miles per hour down. He's averaging 89. It was like that in his WBC outings as well." He added that "everything is six to eight miles per hour down" and called it "not optimistic." *Fantasy Baseball Today, CBS, Mar 24, 2026.* The FanGraphs bullpen power rankings placed the Royals 15th, with the editorial note: "The projection systems don't know that Carlos Estévez has been sitting 89 this spring and looks kind of cooked. [Lucas Erceg](#) looks primed to usurp him for the closer job." *FanGraphs Blog, Mar 23, 2026.* The Locked On Fantasy Baseball podcast also flagged his velocity concerns. *Locked On Fantasy Baseball, Mar 24, 2026.* Even the FantasyPros NL Best Bets podcast noted that "Carlos Esteves led with forty-two" saves last year, establishing the baseline for what could be lost. *FantasyPros Baseball Podcast, Mar 23, 2026.* His composite projection of 349 pts (Pos Rank #20) already reflects middling expectations, and the Steamer projection of 342 is even lower. In a league where SV=7, a closer who can't throw hard enough to close is a serious liability. This is a **SELL HIGH** candidate if any league-mate still values the "closer" label — or an immediate drop candidate if the velocity doesn't recover in the first week.

Robert Suarez (ATL, RP)

Sentiment	NEUTRAL
Lineup	MONITOR
Confidence	MEDIUM (2 sources)
Games This Week	ATL: 5 games
Trend	— (first report)

[Robert Suarez](#) signed a three-year, \$45 million deal with the Braves this offseason after leaving San Diego, and FanGraphs' bullpen rankings placed him as part of the Braves' "grey-muzzled Cerebrus" of late-inning relievers alongside [Raisel Iglesias](#) and [Tyler Kinley](#). The article noted he "posted a 2.91 ERA in four seasons with San Diego" but "did lose nearly a tick off of his average fastball velocity" last year. *FanGraphs Blog, Mar 23, 2026*. The Padres bullpen piece also mentioned San Diego's pen "shouldn't miss a beat" despite losing Suarez. *FanGraphs Blog, Mar 23, 2026*. His composite projection of 298 pts with a Pos Rank of #31 among relievers makes him one of the weaker assets on your roster. In a format where SV=7, he's unlikely to accumulate many saves as the setup man behind Iglesias. His Steamer projection of 288 suggests even the floor is modest. He's a hold for now in deep formats but could be a drop candidate if a higher-upside reliever emerges on waivers.

Kyle Stowers (MIA, OF)

Sentiment	BEARISH
Lineup	STASH (IL)
Confidence	MEDIUM (2 sources)
Games This Week	MIA: 3 games
Trend	— (first report)

[Kyle Stowers](#) re-injured his right hamstring and will miss three to four weeks, which is devastating news for his early-season fantasy value. Scott White confirmed on Fantasy Baseball Today that "Kyle Stowers re-injured his right hamstring and will miss three to four weeks" and subsequently moved him "outside the top 40" outfielders. *Fantasy Baseball Today, CBS, Mar 23, 2026*. FanGraphs' power rankings mentioned Stowers in the Marlins context, noting his "season will be delayed because of a hamstring injury." *FanGraphs Blog, Mar 24, 2026*. His composite projection of 314 pts was already modest (Pos Rank #51), and the Steamer projection of only 263 reflects significant concern about his full-season output. With Miami playing only 3 games this week and Stowers not among them, he's an IL stash. The gap between his composite (314) and

Steamer (263) — a surplus of -66 — was already the worst on your roster among position players. This injury only widens that concern. **Stash on IL** and monitor the hamstring recovery timeline closely.

Robbie Ray (SF, SP)

Sentiment	NEUTRAL
Lineup	START
Confidence	MEDIUM (2 sources)
Games This Week	SF: 5 games
Trend	— (first report)

Robbie Ray has had an encouraging spring that's generating some quiet optimism. Pitcher List's Nick Pollack noted his Saturday start: "5.0 IP, 1 ER, 3 H, 2 BB, 6 K. Ayyyyy, 50% fastballs, with 13% sinkers to LHB!" He noted the slider and sinker feel were "pretty terrible" but liked the changeup usage against RHB. He summarized Ray as "fine" and a "standard Robbie Ray scattershot." *Pitcher List*, Mar 22, 2026. FanGraphs' Sunday Notes column highlighted him among spring training standouts: "San Francisco Giants left-hander Robbie Ray has a 29.2% strikeout rate and has allowed seven hits and three runs over 19-and-two-thirds innings." *FanGraphs Blog*, Mar 22, 2026. His composite projection of 386 pts trails his Steamer projection of 424 significantly (surplus of -43), suggesting the composite may be too pessimistic. With SF playing 5 games this week, Ray should get a start. He's locked into the Giants' rotation as their SP2 behind Logan Webb. The velocity concerns that dogged him post-TJ seem to be mostly behind him, and the strikeout upside remains intriguing. Start him with cautious optimism.

Yusei Kikuchi (LAA, SP)

Sentiment	NEUTRAL
Lineup	START
Confidence	LOW (1 source)
Games This Week	LAA: 6 games
Trend	— (first report)

Kikuchi is slotted as the Angels' SP2 behind Jose Soriano in their opening day rotation, per multiple rotation projection sources. *Pitcher List*, Mar 21, 2026; *Pitcher List*, Mar 22, 2026. The Angels are projected as one of baseball's weakest teams (72-90 per FanGraphs), which limits win potential, but LAA plays 6 games this week — the most of any team on your roster — giving

Kikuchi strong volume opportunity. His composite projection of 364 pts lags well behind Steamer's 428 (surplus of -65), one of the largest gaps on your roster. This suggests the composite is potentially too bearish. In our scoring system where OUT=1.5 and K=0.5, a pitcher who can eat innings and generate strikeouts has value even on a bad team. Start him in Week 1.

Carlos Rodón (NYY, SP)

Sentiment	BULLISH
Lineup	STASH (IL)
Confidence	MEDIUM (2 sources)
Games This Week	NYY: 5 games
Trend	— (first report)

Carlos Rodón is expected to return from the IL before the end of April, and the early reports are extremely promising. In the CBS draft podcast, Chris Towers noted: "velocity reports so far have been very promising... actually up in his first live BP I think from last year." He added that the Yankees bullpen could benefit from Rodón's return, and "they should be very good and it sounds like he'll be back pretty soon." *Fantasy Baseball Today, CBS, Mar 24, 2026*. Scott White moved Rodón up 15 spots in his rankings, placing him at SP53 but noted he's a "stash when he returns" type. *Fantasy Baseball Today, CBS, Mar 20, 2026*. His composite projection of 354 pts vastly underperforms his Steamer projection of 409 (surplus of -75), reflecting the IL time baked into the composite. If he returns healthy and throwing hard, this gap narrows dramatically. **Stash on IL** — this could be one of your best mid-season additions. The velocity being UP from last year is the key bullish signal.

Reid Detmers (LAA, RP)

Sentiment	NEUTRAL
Lineup	MONITOR
Confidence	LOW (1 source)
Games This Week	LAA: 6 games
Trend	— (first report)

Detmers was mentioned in the CBS draft podcast as a sparp (starter/reliever eligible player) who "is throwing a splitter this spring" — a potential new pitch that could add a dimension to his arsenal. *Fantasy Baseball Today, CBS, Mar 24, 2026*. He's listed in the Angels' rotation per Pitcher List projections, though positioned as more of a back-end option. *Pitcher List, Mar 22,*

2026. The FanGraphs bullpen rankings for the Angels (ranked 24th) didn't specifically highlight Detmers but noted the overall weakness of the pen. His composite projection of 331 pts (Pos Rank #75) with a Steamer of 370 represents a -99 surplus — the worst on your entire roster. With LAA playing 6 games, he may get a start or sparp deployment. Monitor the splitter development and whether he's used as a starter or reliever in Week 1 before committing.

Junior Caminero (TB, 3B)

Sentiment	BULLISH
Lineup	START
Confidence	HIGH (3 sources)
Games This Week	TB: 5 games
Trend	— (first report)

Junior Caminero is generating significant expert enthusiasm heading into 2026. FanGraphs' power rankings described his WBC performance as a "star performance for the Dominican Republic" and noted he "looks set to truly establish himself as a superstar." *FanGraphs Blog, Mar 24, 2026*. In the CBS 12-team H2H points draft, Caminero went 12th overall — end of the first round — with Scott White noting he would have taken him if he hadn't gone with Schwarber. *Fantasy Baseball Today, CBS, Mar 24, 2026*. The FantasyPros league winners podcast also highlighted his elite status, with the hosts frequently citing him as a premier draft target. *FantasyPros Baseball Podcast, Mar 24, 2026*. Pitcher List's draft guide listed him as a Round 2 target at 3B alongside Jose Ramirez. *Pitcher List, Mar 21, 2026*. His composite projection of 481 pts (Pos Rank #2 at 3B) with a Steamer of 450 and a surplus of 146 makes him one of the most valuable assets on your roster. With TB playing 5 games this week, he's a locked-in cornerstone. The Rays' move to Tropicana Field continues, and while the team is projected for only 80-82 wins, Caminero's individual talent transcends the team context.

Freddie Freeman (LAD, 1B)

Sentiment	NEUTRAL
Lineup	START
Confidence	MEDIUM (2 sources)
Games This Week	LAD: 5 games
Trend	— (first report)

Freeman remains a rock-solid starter at 1B, though some age-related skepticism is creeping in. In the CBS draft, Scott White noted Freeman was drafted alongside the Olson/Harper/Devers tier and described him as a "batting average specialist" in points leagues, averaging 3.14 points per game last year. *Fantasy Baseball Today, CBS, Mar 24, 2026*. The FantasyPros NL Best Bets podcast mentioned the Dodgers' aging core with "[Freddie Freeman](#), Mookie Bets, everybody another year older" as a factor in their over/under discussion. *FantasyPros Baseball Podcast, Mar 23, 2026*. His composite of 461 pts (Pos Rank #3 at 1B) with Steamer at 482 is solid. The Steamer being higher than the composite is a positive signal. With LAD playing 5 games, Freeman is a confident start. At age 36, the floor remains high even if the ceiling has lowered slightly.

[Zach Neto](#) (LAA, SS)

Sentiment	BULLISH
Lineup	START
Confidence	HIGH (3+ sources)
Games This Week	LAA: 6 games
Trend	— (first report)

[Zach Neto](#) has been a polarizing but well-regarded fantasy asset this spring, though he's had some scary moments recently. Scott White noted on the CBS podcast that "he got hit by another pitch today... it has been a rough week. He had the hand sprain the other day that ended up being a non-issue. Then he gets hit by a pitch on his hand... And then [Roki Sasaki](#) just hit him on the elbow, but I think he stayed in the game." *Fantasy Baseball Today, CBS, Mar 24, 2026*. Despite these concerns, Neto went 111th in the CBS 12-team H2H points draft — a "massive fall" that Scott questioned. The FantasyPros experts love podcast noted his NFBC ADP of 27 versus a consensus ADP of 33.2, signaling expert enthusiasm for his 30-30 potential. *FantasyPros Baseball Podcast, Mar 19, 2026*. Ben Clemens at FanGraphs also mentioned Langford and the Rangers but didn't express concern about individual Angels players. *FanGraphs Blog, Mar 23, 2026*. With LAA playing 6 games this week — the joint-most on your roster — Neto offers excellent volume. His composite of 446 pts (Pos Rank #7 at SS) with a 55-point surplus represents strong value. Start with confidence despite the HBP scares.

Wyatt Langford (TEX, OF)

Sentiment	BULLISH
Lineup	START
Confidence	HIGH (4+ sources)
Games This Week	TEX: 5 games
Trend	— (first report)

Wyatt Langford has been one of the biggest spring training risers, and expert enthusiasm is palpable. The FantasyPros league winners podcast featured him prominently, with Joe Orrico stating: "Jarren Duran, three homers, two steals. He's hitting four hundred... Wyatt Langford, 13 games. He has five homers, 10 runs, 15 RBIs, and a .455 batting average." *FantasyPros Baseball Podcast*, Mar 24, 2026; Mar 20, 2026. Ben Clemens at FanGraphs confirmed his support: "no I like him. I don't have any hot takes about the inaccuracy of projections of their players or anything." *FanGraphs Blog*, Mar 23, 2026. Pitcher List's draft guide listed him as a target, and FanGraphs' Sunday Notes highlighted him among spring standouts: "Texas Rangers outfielder Wyatt Langford is 16-for-36 with three doubles and five home runs." *FanGraphs Blog*, Mar 22, 2026. His composite of 439 pts beats Steamer's 407 by 32 points, and his Pos Rank of #13 among outfielders makes him a solid OF2. With TEX playing 5 games, start him confidently. The oblique/hamstring injury history is the only concern, but the talent is undeniable.

Vinnie Pasquantino (KC, 1B)

Sentiment	BULLISH
Lineup	START
Confidence	MEDIUM (2 sources)
Games This Week	KC: 5 games
Trend	— (first report)

Vinnie Pasquantino's WBC performance has boosted his stock, with the FantasyPros league winners podcast noting his three-home-run game as "the greatest celebration in the history of baseball." *FantasyPros Baseball Podcast*, Mar 24, 2026. In the CBS draft, he was taken at the top of the seventh round (pick ~79) — slightly above his typical ADP — with Frank Stampfl calling him "Vinny P baby!" *Fantasy Baseball Today, CBS*, Mar 24, 2026. His composite of 428 pts (Pos Rank #9 at 1B) with Steamer at 411 shows the composite is actually more optimistic, possibly reflecting the WBC momentum and the ballpark dimension changes in KC. With 5 games for KC this week, he's a confident Util start.

Randy Arozarena (SEA, OF)

Sentiment	NEUTRAL
Lineup	START
Confidence	MEDIUM (2 sources)
Games This Week	SEA: 5 games
Trend	— (first report)

Randy Arozarena was mentioned in the CBS draft as a value pick, with Scott White noting he "averaged 3.02 points per game" last year — "actually more points per game than **James Wood**." White added he was "getting kind of lucky on this one" finding Arozarena at a discount because "I was able to capitalize... before his price rose too much." *Fantasy Baseball Today, CBS, Mar 24, 2026*. FanGraphs' DH rankings noted him in the Mariners' outfield context, and the bullpen rankings highlighted Seattle's strong relief corps. His composite of 425 pts (Pos Rank #15 OF) with Steamer at 402 is solid. Seattle plays 5 games this week. Start him as your OF2 with reasonable expectations.

Jarren Duran (BOS, OF)

Sentiment	BULLISH
Lineup	START
Confidence	HIGH (3 sources)
Games This Week	BOS: 5 games
Trend	— (first report)

Jarren Duran is generating significant expert buzz this spring. The FantasyPros league winners podcast devoted extensive time to him: "Jarren Duran, three homers, two steals. He's hitting four hundred. He looks amazing in spring... I just think the price has come down a little bit too much." Joe Orrico noted his 157 and 160 games played the last two years and called him a potential "top ten outfielder this year in a best case scenario." *FantasyPros Baseball Podcast, Mar 24, 2026*. In the CBS draft, he went at pick ~70, with Frank Stampfl noting he drafted him in the same range. *Fantasy Baseball Today, CBS, Mar 24, 2026*. Ben Clemens at FanGraphs mentioned the Red Sox rotation depth as a positive team context. *FanGraphs Blog, Mar 23, 2026*. His composite of 419 pts (Pos Rank #18 OF) with Steamer at 387 shows the composite is more bullish — a positive signal. With BOS playing 5 games and Duran locked into the lineup, he's a confident start.

Ranger Suárez (BOS, SP)

Sentiment	NEUTRAL
Lineup	START
Confidence	MEDIUM (2 sources)
Games This Week	BOS: 5 games
Trend	— (first report)

Ranger Suárez moved to Boston in the offseason, and Ben Clemens at FanGraphs provided thoughtful analysis of his role: "I do agree that Suárez is currently blocking those guys [Tolle and Early], but... they're kind of making an investment in durability. You can't think the odds of all of Crochet, Gray, and Suárez being healthy by the end of September are THAT high." He views the Red Sox rotation depth as "satisfying the following constraints: maximize the odds of having a good playoff rotation while minimizing the odds of Tolle and Early languishing in the minors." *FanGraphs Blog*, Mar 23, 2026. Pitcher List ranked him at SP53, noting: "If Suárez can find his rhythm early, he'll be solid for another year as he goes underrated for the nth straight year." *Pitcher List*, Mar 20, 2026. His composite of 411 pts trails Steamer's 431 (surplus of -18), suggesting slight undervaluation. With BOS playing 5 games, he should get a start. He's your SP1 by default — not exciting but reliable.

Nathan Eovaldi (TEX, SP)

Sentiment	NEUTRAL
Lineup	START
Confidence	LOW (1 source)
Games This Week	TEX: 5 games
Trend	— (first report)

Eovaldi was mentioned briefly in various contexts. Pitcher List's Nick Pollack noted: "He's healthy and that's all I need to see. He had a sub 2.00 ERA in 130 IP" and ranked him SP28, calling him "I love drafting Eovaldi as my SP #4." *Pitcher List*, Mar 21, 2026; Mar 20, 2026. His composite of 391 pts lags well behind Steamer's 464 (surplus of -38), one of the larger gaps on your roster. This suggests the composite is significantly too bearish. With TEX playing 5 games, he should get a start. Start him confidently as your SP2.

Brandon Nimmo (TEX, OF)

Sentiment	NEUTRAL
Lineup	MONITOR
Confidence	LOW (1 source)
Games This Week	TEX: 5 games
Trend	— (first report)

Nimmo was mentioned as a bench pick in the CBS draft, going in the mid-rounds. Frank Stampfl selected him noting he was "the last of those points league specialists." *Fantasy Baseball Today, CBS, Mar 24, 2026*. His composite of 395 pts with Steamer at 415 shows reasonable alignment. With TEX playing 5 games, he could provide solid utility production off the bench. He's a strong candidate for lineup insertion in weeks with favorable matchups.

Bryson Stott (PHI, 2B)

Sentiment	NEUTRAL
Lineup	START
Confidence	MEDIUM (2 sources)
Games This Week	PHI: 4 games
Trend	— (first report)

Stott was discussed on the Locked On Fantasy Baseball podcast as a spring training standout: "359 batting average, six walks, eight strikeouts, three homers, a steal, six RBIs... age 28, kind of right in the prime of his career." The hosts noted he's "the kind of guy that bounces around all over that hitting order" in Philly. *Locked On Fantasy Baseball, Mar 23, 2026*. However, the CBS draft coverage noted the second base position is thin and Stott is "boring" but reliable: "12 to 15 homers, 250 batting average, 25 plus steals." *Fantasy Baseball Today, CBS, Mar 20, 2026*. His composite of 371 pts (Pos Rank #10 at 2B) with Steamer at 350 and a modest surplus of 6 makes him a set-it-and-forget-it 2B. With PHI playing only 4 games this week, his counting stat ceiling is slightly capped.

Salvador Perez (KC, C)

Sentiment	NEUTRAL
Lineup	START
Confidence	LOW (1 source)
Games This Week	KC: 5 games
Trend	— (first report)

Perez was mentioned in various draft contexts as a reliable veteran catcher. The FantasyPros league winners podcast noted KC's lineup depth, with Perez listed among the hitters Caglianone would bat behind. *FantasyPros Baseball Podcast, Mar 24, 2026*. His composite of 368 pts (Pos Rank #5 at C) with Steamer at 370 shows near-perfect alignment. The fences coming in at Kauffman Stadium could boost his power numbers. With KC playing 5 games, start him as your C1 with confidence.

Christian Walker (HOU, 1B)

Sentiment	NEUTRAL
Lineup	MONITOR
Confidence	LOW (1 source)
Games This Week	HOU: 6 games
Trend	— (first report)

Walker was mentioned in the In This League home league draft context, with the hosts noting his power upside as a utility/bench bat. *In This League Fantasy Baseball, Mar 23, 2026*. His composite of 344 pts (Pos Rank #21 at 1B) with Steamer at only 313 and a surplus of -52 makes him one of the weaker roster spots. HOU plays 6 games this week, which helps his volume. As a bench player, he's fine for matchup-based deployment but doesn't warrant a starting spot over your other options.

Injury Watch

Kyle Stowers (MIA, OF)

Status: IL / OUT 3-4 weeks — re-injured right hamstring *Fantasy Baseball Today, CBS, Mar 23, 2026* **Impact:** Stowers re-aggravated the same hamstring that troubled him previously and will miss the first three to four weeks. With Miami playing only 3 games this week, there's zero urgency. Stash him on an IL spot and monitor the recovery timeline. Given his already modest projections (314 composite, 263 Steamer), consider whether the roster spot might be better used on a waiver target with immediate upside.

Carlos Estévez (KC, RP)

Status: DTD / Questionable — velocity significantly down (89 mph vs. career 95.9 mph) *Fantasy Baseball Today, CBS, Mar 24, 2026; FanGraphs Blog, Mar 23, 2026* **Impact:** While not officially injured, the 6-7 mph velocity decline is deeply concerning and could indicate an undisclosed issue. He has not been placed on the IL, but the Royals bullpen rankings piece noted [Lucas Erceg](#) "looks primed to usurp him for the closer job." If the velocity doesn't return in his first regular-season appearance, this could be a season-long problem. Monitor his first outing closely and have a waiver wire closer target ready.

Carlos Rodón (NYY, SP)

Status: IL / Expected return late April to early May — Tommy John recovery *Fantasy Baseball Today, CBS, Mar 24, 2026* **Impact:** Velocity reports are extremely encouraging — actually UP from last year in his first live BP. He was moved up 15 spots in CBS rankings. Stash on IL with confidence; this is a high-upside return that could significantly bolster your rotation by May. His Steamer projection of 409 dramatically outpaces his composite of 354, reflecting the expected healthy-season production.

Matchup Preview

This week you face the **Cad Bane All Stars**, and the projections paint a challenging picture: your squad is projected for 146 points versus their 162. It's a 16-point deficit heading into the opening week of the season — not insurmountable, but you'll need some favorable variance to pull off the upset.

The Cad Bane All Stars roster is headlined by [Juan Soto](#) (594 pts projected), who is the single most valuable fantasy asset in this matchup by a wide margin. Soto's elite plate discipline and counting stats in the Mets lineup make him a week-winning weapon. They also feature [Elly De La Cruz](#) (484 pts) at shortstop — a player with enormous stolen base upside that can swing H2H matchups single-handedly in categories like SB=2 — and [Cole Ragans](#) (449 pts), one of the premier SP assets in fantasy this year. [Ketel Marte](#) (463 pts) rounds out their elite tier at 2B.

Your counter-punches come from [Junior Caminero](#) (481 pts), who matches up well against their top hitters, and your outfield depth with [Kyle Tucker](#), [Wyatt Langford](#), and [Jarren Duran](#) all projected in the 420-440 range. Your pitching staff is the area of greatest concern — [Ranger Suárez](#), [Nathan Eovaldi](#), and [Robbie Ray](#) are solid but lack a true ace, while the opponent features Ragans, [Ryan Pepiot](#), [Shota Imanaga](#), and [Kyle Bradish](#) among their arms.

The key swing players in this matchup are your high-volume assets on teams with 6 games: [Zach Neto](#) and [Yusei Kikuchi](#) (LAA, 6 games) and [Christian Walker](#) (HOU, 6 games) could accumulate extra counting stats compared to the opponent's Mets players (Juan Soto in NYM, only 3 games). This schedule discrepancy is your biggest advantage — exploit it by ensuring all your LAA, HOU, and CLE players are in your starting lineup. The opponent's most volatile positions are their back-end starters ([Bubba Chandler](#), [Tatsuya Imai](#), [Chase Burns](#), [Mike Burrows](#)) — several are rookies or have significant question marks. If a couple of those arms blow up, the gap closes quickly.

With everyone at 0-0 to start the season, this matchup has no standings implications yet, but starting 1-0 versus starting 0-1 sets the tone psychologically. Focus on maximizing games played and volume.

Waiver Targets

[Griffin Jax](#) (TB, P) – PRIORITY ADD

Projection: 374 pts ROS, #16 at position (RP) [Griffin Jax](#) was acquired by the Rays and now sits atop one of baseball's best bullpens. FanGraphs' bullpen rankings placed the Rays 2nd overall, noting Jax "is as durable and reliable as virtually any reliever in baseball. He ranks third among relievers in WAR the last two seasons combined and is third in relief innings pitched since 2022." *FanGraphs Blog, Mar 23, 2026*. Multiple draft podcasts identified him as a premium closer target. In our scoring system (SV=7, HLD=4), Jax's projected role as the Rays' primary ninth-inning option makes him enormously valuable. At 374 pts projected with a surplus of +36, he's one of the best free agents available. He's the most impactful add you can make this week. **Why it matters for my team:** Your closer situation is precarious with [Dennis Santana](#)'s uncertain role and [Carlos Estévez](#)'s velocity collapse. Jax would immediately become your best reliever and provide premium saves. Consider dropping [Robert Suarez](#) to make room.

[Gleyber Torres](#) (DET, 2B) – SPECULATIVE ADD

Projection: 402 pts ROS, #6 at position Torres was mentioned briefly in CBS drafts going very late, with Scott White noting he had a "2.79 points per game" average last year, "about the same as [Jose Altuve](#)." He added it "was an unusually good plate discipline year for Torres" but acknowledged "unusually bad in other ways." *Fantasy Baseball Today, CBS, Mar 24, 2026*. His

402-pt projection with a +37 surplus as the #6 2B is eye-popping for a free agent. DET plays 5 games this week. **Why it matters for my team:** While [Bryson Stott](#) is your 2B starter, Torres could serve as a Util upgrade over some of your current bench options, or provide injury insurance at a thin position.

Alec Bohm (PHI, 3B) – WATCHLIST

Projection: 355 pts ROS, #8 at position Bohm was mentioned in the CBS draft as a “batting average stabilizer” at third base in roto leagues, going late in drafts. *Fantasy Baseball Today, CBS, Mar 24, 2026; Mar 19, 2026.* His 355-pt projection with +20 surplus at Pos Rank #8 makes him a solid 3B option. With PHI only playing 4 games, he’s not an urgent add but worth monitoring. **Why it matters for my team:** Your roster doesn’t have a backup 3B behind [Junior Caminero](#). Bohm provides batting average safety and solid counting stats as emergency depth.

Adley Rutschman (BAL, C) – WATCHLIST

Projection: 360 pts ROS, #7 at position Rutschman was discussed in the CBS podcasts with some skepticism about whether he’ll recapture past form, but at 360 pts projected with +18 surplus, he’s a notable free agent in a 10-team league. *Fantasy Baseball Today, CBS, Mar 20, 2026.* BAL plays 4 games this week. **Why it matters for my team:** If [Salvador Perez](#) underperforms early, Rutschman is a safety valve. But this is not urgent given Perez’s reliability.

Caleb Durbin (BOS, 3B) – SPECULATIVE ADD

Projection: 347 pts ROS, #9 at position Durbin was just named the Red Sox starting third baseman per multiple sources. The In This League podcast noted: “[Caleb Durbin](#), according to Caleb Durbin, he’s been named the Red Sox starting third baseman... I think there’s a case that he could be a 15-30 guy this year.” *In This League Fantasy Baseball, Mar 19, 2026.* His 347-pt projection with +12 surplus and BOS playing 5 games makes him an interesting add with stolen base upside. **Why it matters for my team:** If you need speed or 3B depth, Durbin’s role with the Red Sox and his 15-HR/30-SB upside profile makes him worth a speculative grab, especially in our scoring where SB=2.

Trade Signals

Sell High Candidates (My Roster)

Carlos Estévez (KC, RP) — The velocity decline from 95.9 to 89 mph is the most alarming signal on your entire roster. If any league-mate is not paying attention to spring velocity reports and still sees “Royals closer” next to his name, this is the time to move him. His composite projection of 349 pts still looks respectable on paper, and his 42-save season last year carries weight. Target

a mid-tier SP or a more reliable RP in return. Potential trade partners: look for teams in your league that are thin on closers. **Fire Brian Cashman** or **Elan Sleazebaggano Deathsticks** might be desperate for saves — package Estévez with a bench bat to acquire a reliable arm.

Buy Low Targets (Other Teams)

Chase Burns (CIN, SP) — Owned by Cad Bane All Stars (your opponent this week, so wait until after the matchup). Burns' ADP has been falling due to spring concerns and rotation uncertainty, but his stuff is elite. The FantasyPros podcasts and Pitcher List both flagged the negative discourse as overblown. *FantasyPros Baseball Podcast, Mar 24, 2026; Pitcher List, Mar 20, 2026*. His 316-pt projection may be too low. After your matchup this week, approach the Cad Bane owner about a buy-low trade — they may be willing to move him if his first start doesn't go well.

Spencer Torkelson (DET, 1B) — Owned by Cad Bane All Stars (again, wait until after the matchup). His 392-pt projection is reasonable but he's had a rough spring (.194 in 38 AB). FanGraphs' Sunday Notes featured his own comments about "falling into a spring training trap." *FanGraphs Blog, Mar 22, 2026*. He could be available cheaply if the owner is frustrated. You could offer **Christian Walker** (similar profile, worse projection) plus a sweetener.

Shota Imanaga (CHC, SP) — Owned by Cad Bane All Stars. His velocity has been UP this spring, and Pitcher List ranked him SP27 noting "his four-seamer is back up two ticks in the spring, with elite pitch separation." *Pitcher List, Mar 20, 2026*. At 366 pts projected, he's undervalued. After this week's matchup, explore whether the opponent would move him as part of a package.

Projection Watch

Nathan Eovaldi (TEX, SP): The gap between his composite projection (391 pts) and Steamer (464 pts) is a massive 73 points — one of the largest on your roster. Pitcher List ranked him SP28, calling him a pitcher they "love drafting as my SP #4" and noting "He's healthy and that's all I need to see." The Steamer projection reflects a pitcher who threw with a sub-2.00 ERA in 130 IP last year. If Steamer is correct and Eovaldi provides 464 pts of value, he's performing at SP1 levels on your team. **Action: Hold confidently; do not sell.**

Yusei Kikuchi (LAA, SP): Another enormous composite-vs-Steamer gap: 364 vs. 428, a 64-point difference. The composite has him at Pos Rank #49 among SPs while Steamer sees him as more of a #25-30 arm. This discrepancy likely reflects composite systems weighting his inconsistent recent history more heavily, while Steamer is more optimistic about his current form. With LAA playing 6 games this week, any strong early performance could shift this narrative quickly. **Action: Start and monitor; if he delivers strong early results, his trade value spikes.**

Carlos Rodón (NYY, SP): The 354 composite vs. 409 Steamer gap (55 points) exists almost entirely because of his IL time. The velocity reports being UP from last year are the most bullish signal imaginable for a TJ recovery. If Rodón returns throwing 96+ as reported, the Steamer projection could be conservative. Scott White moved him up 15 spots in rankings. **Action: Stash on IL; do not trade under any circumstances.**

Around the League

The opening week of the 2026 MLB season arrives with several storylines dominating expert discourse across all content sources.

The **World Baseball Classic aftermath** continues to influence fantasy valuations significantly. Venezuela's championship run boosted several players, while the USA's loss created some interesting narratives. Ben Clemens at FanGraphs ran PitchingBot models on WBC data and found [Nolan McLean](#) had the best stuff grades of any starter in the tournament — better than [Paul Skenes](#), [Tarik Skubal](#), or [Logan Webb](#). [Mason Miller](#) topped all pitchers overall with an 82 stuff grade. Meanwhile, several players returned with velocity concerns or minor injuries, including [Spencer Strider](#) (oblique) and [Seiya Suzuki](#) (PCL sprain).

The **Spencer Strider oblique injury** is one of the biggest breaking stories. He'll start the season on the IL, with [Jose Suarez](#) expected to fill the SP5 role rather than top prospect [Didier Fuentes](#), who will remain in the bullpen. Scott White dropped Strider outside the top 50 in his rankings and expressed ongoing concern about Strider's fastball not being "back to form." *Fantasy Baseball Today, CBS, Mar 24, 2026.*

[Connelly Early](#) has made the **Red Sox opening day roster**, which is a significant development for fantasy. The CBS podcast extensively discussed his potential, with Scott White calling him "awesome" and noting his "six-pitch arsenal" where "they're all capable of missing bats." He was ranked as high as SP57 by some. *Fantasy Baseball Today, CBS, Mar 24, 2026; RotoWire, Mar 24, 2026.*

The **Dodgers rotation mess** continues to generate headlines. [Roki Sasaki](#) has been confirmed for the rotation despite a 16.00 ERA this spring. Emmett Sheehan's role was initially uncertain (piggyback vs. rotation) but was ultimately confirmed as a rotation starter late Monday. His velocity being down to 93.8 mph from 95.6 last year is generating concern from multiple analysts, including Nick Pollack at Pitcher List.

[JJ Wetherholt](#) has made the **Cardinals' opening day roster** at second base, which was widely expected. In the CBS draft, he went at pick 146, with Scott White noting he should be treated "like we do [Bo Bichette](#)" — a shortstop who'll pick up eligibility at a weaker position. *Fantasy Baseball Today, CBS, Mar 24, 2026.*

The **Pittsburgh Pirates closer situation** is generating concern after Don Kelly's comments about potentially using [Dennis Santana](#) in non-traditional ways. Multiple sources flagged this as a potential committee situation.

Industry-wide, the **catcher position depth** is being universally praised as the best in recent memory. FanGraphs' DH power rankings noted the proliferation of catchers who "hit well enough to DH" as a major theme across many organizations. Fourteen catchers are projected for a 110+ wRC+ — the most in ZiPS history.

Cardinals Corner

The Cardinals are projected for a 75-87 record with just 8.6% playoff odds, per FanGraphs' Opening Day power rankings. Jake Mailhot's tier analysis placed them in the "Under Construction" tier, noting the team has "already torn off the Band-Aid this winter, trading away [Nolan Arenado](#), [Sonny Gray](#), [Willson Contreras](#), and [Brendan Donovan](#)." He highlighted the key development goals: "a promising debut from [JJ Wetherholt](#), any sign of life from [Jordan Walker](#) and [Nolan Gorman](#), and continued development from [Masyn Winn](#) and [Matthew Liberatore](#)." *FanGraphs Blog, Mar 24, 2026.*

Ben Clemens at FanGraphs weighed in on the rotation, noting he thinks Liberatore "is what he is at this point, an average innings eater, which is valuable" and added that [Dustin May](#) "looks electric... he's been in the majors since 2019 and has thrown 324 innings." He was positive about the Cardinals signing May, calling it a potential trade chip or extension candidate. *FanGraphs Blog, Mar 23, 2026.*

The FanGraphs bullpen rankings placed St. Louis 27th, describing it as "a bunch of guys" outside of [Riley O'Brien](#) and [Matt Svanson](#). [Ryne Stanek](#) was called "on the line between guy and Guy." *FanGraphs Blog, Mar 23, 2026.*

For your league, **Ithilien** (your brother's team) owns three Cardinals: [Alec Burleson](#) (378 pts), [Ivan Herrera](#) (354 pts), and [JJ Wetherholt](#) (316 pts). Burleson is projected as a solid middle-tier 1B/OF; Herrera is interesting as a DH-primary with catcher upside; and Wetherholt has high-ceiling 2B eligibility value. The FantasyPros NL Best Bets podcast mentioned Wetherholt's +550 NL ROY odds as the favorite. *FantasyPros Baseball Podcast, Mar 23, 2026.*

Masyn Winn (370 pts, free agent) is a Cardinals player worth monitoring on waivers. STL plays only 4 games this week, limiting the value of Cardinals assets in the opening matchup.

Sibling Rivalry

Ithilien enters the 2026 season at 0-0 like everyone else, but their roster construction suggests they're built for the long haul. Their top assets are [Paul Skenes](#) (594 pts) and [Garrett Crochet](#) (584 pts) — two of the best SP assets in the entire league. Combined with [Kyle Schwarber](#) (495 pts), [Framber Valdez](#) (492 pts), and [Jesús Luzardo](#) (464 pts), they have elite pitching depth.

Their potential weaknesses are at catcher ([Ivan Herrera](#) at 354 pts, [Drake Baldwin](#) at 346 pts) and in their back-end roster spots ([Sal Stewart](#) at 331 pts, [Jac Caglianone](#) at 298 pts). Both Stewart and Caglianone are rookies with significant upside but also significant downside.

Trade leverage: Your brother's team is SP-heavy with Skenes, Crochet, Valdez, Luzardo, [Nick Pivetta](#), [MacKenzie Gore](#), [Gavin Williams](#), and [Jack Flaherty](#). That's more quality arms than he can start. Meanwhile, he may be light on proven bats, with [George Springer](#) (421 pts) and [Alex Bregman](#) (426 pts) both entering their mid-30s.

Buy-low target: Jack Flaherty (384 pts) is buried on his roster and may be expendable given his pitching depth. Flaherty has been inconsistent but can contribute in good matchups.

Trade suggestion: Offer [Nathan Eovaldi](#) (391 pts, whose Steamer of 464 suggests he's undervalued) plus [Brandon Nimmo](#) (395 pts) for [Jackson Chourio](#) (458 pts). Frame it as two proven assets for one young stud. Your brother gets immediate depth; you get a premium young outfielder to upgrade your lineup. Alternative: offer [Vinnie Pasquantino](#) + [Reid Detmers](#) for Chourio if he values the 1B need.

Action Items

- [] **PRIORITY ADD:** [Griffin Jax](#) (TB, P) — drop [Robert Suarez](#) to make room; elite save source in premium bullpen
- [] **SELL HIGH:** [Carlos Estévez](#) (KC, RP) — trade before Week 1 velocity becomes public knowledge; target a mid-tier SP or stable closer
- [] **MONITOR:** [Dennis Santana](#) (PIT, RP) — watch first week's usage pattern; if saves are truly split, consider dropping
- [] **MONITOR:** [Carlos Rodón](#) (NYY, SP) — stash on IL; velocity reports are extremely encouraging for late-April return
- [] **IL STASH:** [Kyle Stowers](#) (MIA, OF) — move to IL; 3-4 week timeline, revisit in late April
- [] **MONITOR:** [Reid Detmers](#) (LAA, RP) — watch Week 1 role (starter vs. reliever) and new splitter development
- [] **MONITOR:** [Christian Walker](#) (HOU, 1B) — bench player with 6-game week; deploy in Util if favorable matchups arise

- [] **SPECULATIVE ADD:** [Caleb Durbin](#) (BOS, 3B) — newly named starter with 15/30 upside; consider for bench if roster space allows
 - [] **MONITOR:** [Zach Neto](#) (LAA, SS) — HBP concerns this spring; ensure no lingering effects in Week 1 starts
-

Sources Analyzed

Podcasts

- **Fantasy Baseball Today (CBS)** — Spencer Strider to the IL! Connelly Early Makes the Red Sox! (3/24 Fantasy Baseball Podcast) (Mar 24, 2026)
- **FantasyPros Baseball Podcast** — [Fantasy Baseball LEAGUE WINNERS: Top 20 High-Upside Picks for 2026 \(Ep. 1186\)](#) (Mar 24, 2026)
- **Locked On Fantasy Baseball** — [Early Season Cheap Saves Options! | Fantasy Baseball 2026](#) (Mar 24, 2026)
- **Fantasy Baseball Today (CBS)** — Final 12-Team H2H Points Listener League Draft! (3/24 Fantasy Baseball Podcast) (Mar 24, 2026)
- **FantasyPros Baseball Podcast** — [National League Best Bets | MLB Futures & Predictions \(Ep. 1185\)](#) (Mar 23, 2026)
- **Locked On Fantasy Baseball** — [ACE ALERT ! Why Logan Gilbert MUST Anchor Yor Fantasy Baseball Rotation In 2026 !](#) (Mar 23, 2026)
- **Locked On Fantasy Baseball** — [MUST ADD WATCH PLAYERS! | Fantasy Baseball 2026](#) (Mar 23, 2026)
- **Fantasy Baseball Today (CBS)** — Opening Day Rosters! Prospects, Rotations & More! (3/23 Fantasy Baseball Podcast) (Mar 23, 2026)
- **In This League Fantasy Baseball** — [Episode 854 - The Home League Draft](#) (Mar 23, 2026)
- **Fantasy Baseball Today (CBS)** — Final Mailbag! OBP Rankings, Garrett Crochet's Innings & More! (3/21 Fantasy Baseball Podcast) (Mar 21, 2026)
- **FantasyPros Baseball Podcast** — [12-Team Head-To-Head Mock Draft \(Ep. 1184\)](#) (Mar 20, 2026)
- **Locked On Fantasy Baseball** — [Jo Adell's POWER SURGE—Fantasy Baseball's Must-Own OF in 2026?](#) (Mar 20, 2026)
- **Locked On Fantasy Baseball** — [MUST DRAFT MY GUYS ! Draft These Players To Win You 2026 Fantasy Baseball League !](#) (Mar 20, 2026)
- **FantasyPros Baseball Podcast** — [Which Projections to Trust + Spring Training ADP Risers with Steve Gardner \(Ep. 1183\)](#) (Mar 20, 2026)
- **Fantasy Baseball Today (CBS)** — Players We Keep Drafting & Fading in 2026 Drafts! (3/20 Fantasy Baseball Podcast) (Mar 20, 2026)
- **In This League Fantasy Baseball** — [Episode 853 - Fantasy Baseball LIVE Q&A](#) (Mar 19, 2026)

- **FantasyPros Baseball Podcast** — [Which Players Do the Experts Love? | 2026 Fantasy Baseball Draft Targets \(Ep. 1182\)](#) (Mar 19, 2026)
- **Fantasy Baseball Today (CBS)** — Gerrit Cole Makes His Return! Updates on Seiya Suzuki & Jeremy Peña (3/19 Fantasy Baseball Podcast) (Mar 19, 2026)
- **Fantasy Baseball Today (CBS)** — Final 12-Team Roto Mock Draft with Sam Wirsching! (3/19 Fantasy Baseball Podcast) (Mar 19, 2026)
- **FantasyPros Baseball Podcast** — [Fantasy Draft Court: Paul Sporer vs. Justin Mason \(Ep. 1181\)](#) (Mar 18, 2026)

Blogs

- **FanGraphs Blog** — [FanGraphs Power Rankings: Opening Day 2026 \(No. 19–30\)](#) (Mar 24, 2026)
- **FanGraphs Blog** — [Effectively Wild is Going Freemium](#) (Mar 24, 2026)
- **RotoWire MLB News** — [Connelly Early: Wins spot in Boston rotation](#) (Mar 24, 2026)
- **RotoWire MLB News** — [Chase DeLauter: Goes deep twice](#) (Mar 24, 2026)
- **RotoWire MLB News** — [Corbin Carroll: Gets start in field](#) (Mar 24, 2026)
- **FanGraphs Blog** — [Ben Clemens FanGraphs Chat – 3/23/26](#) (Mar 23, 2026)
- **FanGraphs Blog** — [2026 Positional Power Rankings: Bullpen \(No. 1-15\)](#) (Mar 23, 2026)
- **Pitcher List** — [2026 Spring Training Breakout Games Day 3](#) (Mar 23, 2026)
- **FanGraphs Blog** — [Phillies Re-Extend Cristopher Sánchez](#) (Mar 23, 2026)
- **FanGraphs Blog** — [2026 Positional Power Rankings: Bullpen \(No. 16-30\)](#) (Mar 23, 2026)
- **Pitcher List** — [Where PECOTA and Pitcher List Projections Disagree](#) (Mar 23, 2026)
- **FanGraphs Blog** — [Let's Peruse Some Pitch Modeling Highlights From the WBC](#) (Mar 23, 2026)
- **FanGraphs Blog** — [Job Posting: New York Mets – Applied AI Engineer](#) (Mar 23, 2026)
- **RotoWire MLB News** — [Mickey Moniak: Exits early Monday](#) (Mar 23, 2026)
- **RotoWire MLB News** — [Pete Crow-Armstrong: Inks extension with Cubs](#) (Mar 23, 2026)
- **Pitcher List** — [Daily Starting Pitcher News And Spring SP Roundup – 3-22-26](#) (Mar 22, 2026)
- **FanGraphs Blog** — [Sunday Notes: Trey Yesavage is Pretty Much the Same \(Splitter-Cutting\) Dude](#) (Mar 22, 2026)
- **Pitcher List** — [OTW 247 – Born To Draft Wild; First FAAB Run](#) (Mar 22, 2026)
- **Pitcher List** — [Ultimate Fantasy Baseball Draft Guide '26 – Who To Draft & When UPDATE 3/21](#) (Mar 21, 2026)
- **Pitcher List** — [2026 Spring Training Breakout Games Day 2](#) (Mar 21, 2026)
- **Pitcher List** — [Daily Starting Pitcher News And Spring SP Roundup – 3-21-26](#) (Mar 21, 2026)
- **Pitcher List** — [TWF 142 – Spring Training Battles We're Watching](#) (Mar 21, 2026)
- **FanGraphs Blog** — [FanGraphs Weekly Mailbag: March 21, 2026](#) (Mar 21, 2026)
- **Pitcher List** — [Top 100 Starting Pitchers For 2026 Fantasy Baseball: 3/20 UPDATE](#) (Mar 20, 2026)
- **FanGraphs Blog** — [2026 Positional Power Rankings: Designated Hitter](#) (Mar 20, 2026)

- Pitcher List — [2026 Spring Training Breakout Games Day 1](#) (Mar 20, 2026)
-